

Jacobian-lens trajectories under medical SFT

`gemma-3-270m-it`, `gemma-3-1b-it`, `gemma-3-4b-it`

July 30, 2026

Full fine-tune on `mix_default`, lr $1e-5$, log-spaced checkpoints to step 4882

Setup

- **Three arms**, identical seed and data order: `gemma-3-{270m,1b,4b}-it`, full FT, $lr = 1e-5$, completion-only loss.
- **Log-spaced checkpoints** $\{1, 2, 4, \dots, 4096\} + \text{final (4882)}$. $t = 0$ is the untouched base, prepended by the probe.
- **Lens refit per checkpoint** on a frozen 1000-sequence generic (non-medical) WikiText corpus, taken from `jlen's` own `load_wikitext_prompts` — the lens is a function of the weights.
- **Concordance** on the frozen 193-prompt probe set: 50 general + 50 medical (hand-authored one-hop cloze, style-matched control pairs) + 93 multihop from `jlen's` `lens-eval-multihop.json`.
- **Behavioral** trajectory in parallel: MedQA, MedMCQA, PubMedQA, reported as *answered* accuracy with answer rate alongside. **Scored by an LLM judge**, not a regex — see the instrument slide.

All lens numbers below are the **mean over the last $n/5$ source layers** (the probe's `kl_final` / `top1_final`): 3 layers at 270m, 5 at 1b, 6 at 4b. Where the single final layer disagrees, it is called out explicitly — see the read-out caveat. Coverage: 14 / 15 / 14 points (270m / 1b / 4b) — all three complete. **Behavioral: 4b is judge-scored and complete (14 points incl. $t=0$); 270m and 1b are still on the superseded regex scorer and are *not* comparable to it.**

The probe step in detail

Runs in `.venv-jlens` (transformers 5.14.1 + jlens @ 581d398) — a second env, because the training pin 4.53.2 is hard-incompatible. Imports nothing from `gemma_med`.

Per checkpoint (base prepended as step 0, then `checkpoint-*`):

1. **Load** → `jlens.from_hf(hf, tok)`. Forced text-only Gemma3ForCausalLM; any loader leaving a weight missing is *rejected*, not accepted.
2. **Fit** a fresh lens: `jlens.fit(model, corpus, dim_batch=16, max_seq_len=128)` on the frozen 1000-seq WikiText corpus. *Dominates runtime*.
3. **Concordance**: for each of the 193 probes, `lens.apply(model, prompt, positions=[-1])` → per source layer, top-1 agreement and $KL(model \parallel lens)$ at the last token.
4. **Drift** vs. $t=0$, per layer: relative Frobenius $\|J_l - J_l^0\| / \|J_l^0\|$ and cosine.

Output. One `fsync'd` JSON row per checkpoint in `metrics.jsonl`, plus W&B scalars keyed by training step. Resumable: completed steps are skipped and the fit checkpoints every 50 prompts, so a requeue does not wipe the trajectory.

Invariants that make the trajectory comparable

- **One load path for all points.** Letting `Auto*` pick per-path would read $t=0$ through the multimodal wrapper and later points through the text model — two forwards on one trajectory, silently corrupting drift.
- **Lens refit every time.** J is a function of the weights.
- **Corpus and probe set frozen** across all checkpoints and sizes.
- **$t=0$ lens cached in fp32**, so a resumed run's drift baseline matches a fresh run's exactly.

Reading the metrics — the two drift measures

J_l = lens Jacobian at source layer l ; J_l^0 = the same layer in the $t=0$ base lens. n = number of source layers (18 / 26 / 34 at 270m / 1b / 4b). Both measures are computed per layer, then averaged over all n ; both are exactly 0 / 1 at $t=0$ by construction.

Metric	How it is computed	Direction
rel. Frobenius relfro_mean	$\ J_l - J_l^0\ _F / \ J_l^0\ _F$ — the <i>size</i> of the change, normalised by the base magnitude.	Neither better nor worse. It says <i>how far</i> the lens moved, not whether the move helped. Larger = more change.
cosine cos_mean	$\langle J_l, J_l^0 \rangle / (\ J_l\ \ J_l^0\)$, flattened over all entries — the <i>direction</i> of the change.	Neither. 1 = pointing the same way as the base; lower = more rotation. Bounded above by 1.

Why both. They can move independently: a lens can grow in magnitude without rotating (relfro up, cosine ≈ 1) or rotate without changing size. In practice they track each other here, which is itself a mild sanity check on the fit.

Not comparable across sizes. J_l has a different shape at every arm, so only these normalised scalars travel — never a raw Jacobian entry.

Reading the metrics — the four faithfulness measures

All four compare the **lens read-out** against the **model's actual next-token distribution**, at the last prompt token, averaged over the prompts of one cue. They differ in which layers they read and how they score.

Metric	How it is computed	Direction
faithfulness KL kl_final	KL(model lens), averaged over the last $n/5$ layers . <i>The workhorse metric.</i>	Lower is better — the lens predicts what the model actually says. 0 = perfect; unbounded above.
top-1 agreement top1_final	Fraction of prompts where $\arg \max \text{ lens} = \arg \max \text{ model}$, same last- $n/5$ layers.	Higher is better , range 0–1. Much coarser than KL — see caveats.
top1_auc	The same agreement averaged over all n layers , not just the top fifth. Despite the name, a mean rather than an integral.	Higher is better — agreement holds deeper down the stack, not only near the output.
crossover_frac	Shallowest layer whose top-1 agreement reaches 0.5, as a fraction of depth; 1.0 if it never does.	Lower is better — the lens locks onto the model's answer earlier in depth.

Cues: `general` / `medical` are the 50+50 hand-authored style-matched pairs; `multihop` the 93 externally sourced prompts. *The cue is the unit of comparison* — `medical` is read against `general`, never on its own. This deck reports `kl_final` and `top1_final`; the other two are computed and stored but not used.

Reading the metrics — direction, and what not to do

Behavioral metrics

- **answer rate** — % of generations that committed to an option. **Higher better**. A pure *format* measure.
- **answered accuracy** — accuracy among those only. **Higher better**. **This is the knowledge signal**.
- **raw accuracy** — non-answers counted wrong. **Higher better**, but confounded: it moves when *either* knowledge or formatting moves.

Why it matters: on 4b MedQA, raw accuracy falls 52.9 → 43.0 by step 512 — which reads as catastrophic forgetting. Answered accuracy over the same span is 53.1 → 51.4, essentially flat. The entire drop is the answer rate going 99.5% → 83.8%. Reporting raw alone inverts the finding, at both sizes where it has been checked.

Directional summary. Drift (relfro ↑, cosine ↓) says the lens *changed*; KL ↑ and top-1 ↓ say the lens *got worse at predicting the model*. The two are independent: a lens can move a long way and stay faithful, or barely move and lose faithfulness. Most of this deck is about which of those happened at each size.

Three rules for reading these numbers

1. **Never compare absolute KL across sizes.** `kl_final` averages a *different number of layers* per arm (3 / 5 / 6), over models of different depth and width. Only the **within-arm Δ from $t=0$** is comparable across arms.
2. **Always read against $t=0$.** Every figure carries the untuned base as a dashed line or a pale bar. A finetuned-only number says nothing.
3. **Name the read-out.** “KL” is ambiguous: the layer mean and the single final layer disagree in sign on 270m medical. This deck is the **layer mean** throughout.

Five findings

1. **Drift has a sharp onset, then saturates** — and at 4b it partly *retreats*. The Jacobian finishes moving in the first ~ 100 steps; the remaining 97% of training adds nothing.
2. **The faithfulness cost of medical SFT scales with model size.** ΔKL on general is $+0.09 / +0.54 / +2.08$ and on multihop $+0.02 / +1.01 / +1.63$ at 270m / 1b / 4b — monotone in size on both out-of-domain cues.
3. **The medical cue is not protected at 4b.** This overturns the two-arm reading. Medical KL goes $-0.05 / -0.37 / +1.19$: flat at 270m, better at 1b, clearly *worse* at 4b.
4. **Medical SFT works at 4b — and the lens cost is paid anyway.** $+5.3 / +8.3 / +14.6$ pp answered accuracy on MedQA / MedMCQA / PubMedQA over the untuned base. **So the size where faithfulness degrades most is also the size that learns most**; the two are not in tension.
5. **Drift leads format collapse, both lead accuracy** — now confirmed at 4b. Drift vs. answer rate is $r = -0.74$ (MedQA) / -0.91 (MedMCQA); drift vs. *answered* accuracy is $+0.10 / +0.37$. The lens tracks formatting, not competence.

The two-arm version of this deck led with “medical holds or improves.” At three sizes that is no longer the finding: what generalises is the *cost*, which grows with scale on every cue — while the *benefit* grows with scale too.

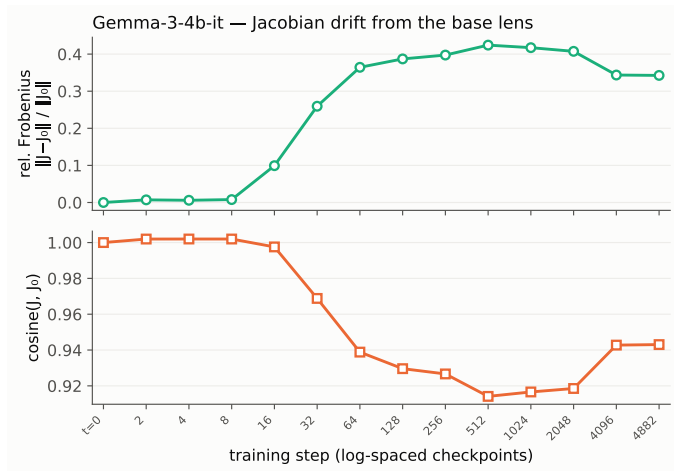
1. Drift onsets sharply, then saturates

	onset	plateau	peak relfro	final relfro / cos (layer mean)
270m-it	steps 32–64	~step 128	0.250	0.249 / 0.976
1b-it	steps 8–32	~step 64	0.308	0.279 / 0.956
4b-it	steps 8–32	~step 128	0.424	0.343 / 0.943

- Nothing moves for the first ~ 8 steps (mean rel. Frobenius ≤ 0.008 at all three sizes).
- Then the Jacobian swings hard over roughly *one decade* of steps, and flatlines. **Onset is earlier and the swing larger the bigger the model** (final relfro $0.249 < 0.279 < 0.343$).
- **New at 4b: a late partial retreat.** Peak 0.424 at step 512 $\rightarrow$ 0.343 at 4882, a 19% walk-back toward the base lens. 1b shows a hint of the same (-9% from its step-2048 peak); 270m is flat.

Most robust result — holds at all three sizes, and under either the layer mean or the per-layer max (max: 0.349 / 0.398 / 0.479).

1. Drift — 4b-it



The cosine panel reads slightly *above* 1.0 at steps 2–8. Cosine cannot exceed 1: this is fp32 dot-product accumulation over $\sim 6.5\text{M}$ entries per layer while the norms use a stabler path. It is visible only where drift is ≈ 0 and affects no step ≥ 16 .

2. The faithfulness cost scales with model size

Lens $\leftrightarrow$ model KL, mean over the last $n/5$ layers (the probe's `kl_final`) — *lower = lens predicts the model better*. Base $\rightarrow$ final checkpoint.

	KL general			KL medical			KL multihop (OOD)		
270m-it	3.407	$\rightarrow$	3.497 (+0.09)	5.388	$\rightarrow$	5.340 (-0.05)	1.958	$\rightarrow$	1.975 (+0.02)
1b-it	2.684	$\rightarrow$	3.229 (+0.54)	4.682	$\rightarrow$	4.314 (-0.37)	2.423	$\rightarrow$	3.430 (+1.01)
4b-it	2.163	$\rightarrow$	4.243 (+2.08)	4.683	$\rightarrow$	5.867 (+1.19)	4.088	$\rightarrow$	5.715 (+1.63)
top-1 medical:	270m	0.260	$\rightarrow$ 0.260 (flat)	1b	0.448	$\rightarrow$ 0.572	4b	0.677	$\rightarrow$ 0.660

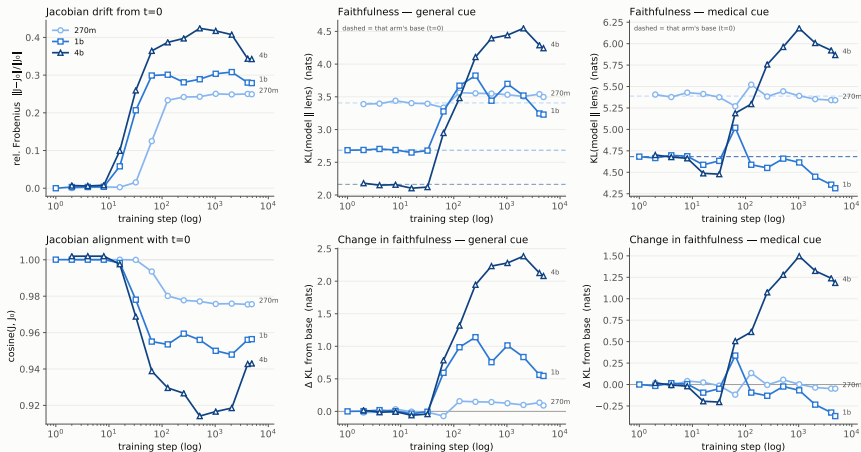
- **Monotone in size on both out-of-domain cues.** general $+0.09 \rightarrow +0.54 \rightarrow +2.08$; multihop $+0.02 \rightarrow +1.01 \rightarrow +1.63$. Nothing here reverses with scale.
- **Bigger models start more faithful and lose more of it.** Base general KL falls with size ($3.41 \rightarrow 2.68 \rightarrow 2.16$) while the damage grows — so the ranking at $t=0$ is the reverse of the ranking after SFT.

Read-out check — the 270m disagreement does *not* recur. At 4b the layer mean and the single final layer agree in sign on all three cues (general $+2.08$ vs. $+0.34$, medical $+1.19$ vs. $+0.09$, multihop $+1.63$ vs. $+0.24$).

The lone sign flip in this study remains 270m medical.

2. All three arms on one axis

Gemma-3 -it · medical SFT · j-lens trajectory by model size · KL = mean over the last n/5 source layers



Arms shaded light→dark by size (an *ordinal* ramp — size is ordered, so it does not take categorical hues). x is the real training step on a log axis, since the arms have different step grids; $t=0$ is each arm's dashed baseline (top row) and the zero line (bottom row), never a point.

3. The medical cue is not protected at 4b

The two-arm deck read this section as “medical holds or improves, and the cost is paid out-of-domain.”

At 4b that is false — medical degrades by +1.19 nats.

	$\Delta\text{KL medical}$	reading
270m-it	-0.05	flat — the lens barely registers the fine-tune
1b-it	-0.37	genuinely better, and top-1 agrees (+0.124)
4b-it	+1.19	clearly worse, and top-1 agrees (-0.017)

- **What survives:** medical is always the *least damaged* cue of the three at its own size. At 4b, general +2.08 and multihop +1.63 are both worse than medical's +1.19.
- **What does not survive:** “medical improves.” That was a 1b-shaped result, and 1b is the only arm where it happens.

So medical SFT does buy the medical cue *relative* ground at every size — but at 4b it buys relative ground while everything, including medicine, gets absolutely less faithful.

3. The domain gap narrows — at 4b from one end only

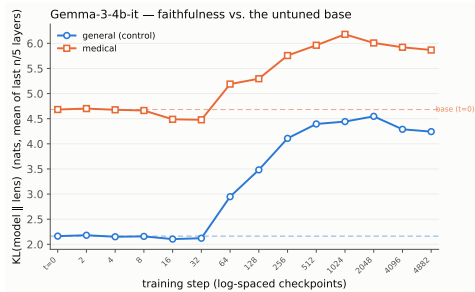
Within each arm the medical cue starts 2–2.5 nats less faithful than general. **All three arms narrow that gap** — but not by the same mechanism.

	$t=0$	final	Δ	closes by
270m-it	1.982	1.843	-0.139	both ends
1b-it	1.998	1.085	-0.912	both ends
4b-it	2.520	1.624	-0.896	general only

At 270m and 1b the gap closes **from both ends** — medical improves *and* general regresses toward it.

At 4b it closes from one end: both cues degrade, general just faster (+2.08 vs. +1.19). **An identical -0.9 gap change means opposite things at 1b and 4b** — which is why the gap is never reported on its own.

multihop degrades at *all three* sizes (+0.02 / +1.01 / +1.63).

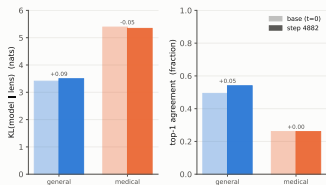


The 4b panel alone: *both* curves rise away from their dashed $t=0$ baselines, the general one further. The 270m and 1b equivalents are on the previous slide.

3. Base vs. finetuned, side by side

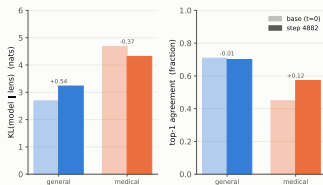
270m-it

Gemma-3-270m-it — base ($t=0$) vs. step 4882 · mean of last $n/5$ layers



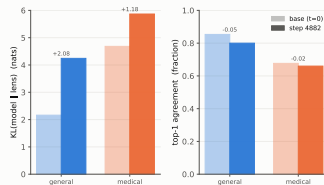
1b-it

Gemma-3-1b-it — base ($t=0$) vs. step 4882 · mean of last $n/5$ layers



4b-it

Gemma-3-4b-it — base ($t=0$) vs. step 4882 · mean of last $n/5$ layers



Pale bar = untuned base ($t=0$), solid = step 4882. All three figures are pinned to the same axes (KL 0–6 nats, top-1 0–1), so the panels are directly superimposable — but compare the Δ *labels*, not the bar heights: absolute KL is not comparable across sizes (different depth and width, and a different number of layers in the $n/5$ mean). Read that way, 270m's largest KL move (+0.09) is about a quarter of 1b's smallest (−0.37), and 4b's smallest (+1.19) is larger than either arm's biggest.

4. The scoring instrument changed

Behavioral scoring is no longer a regex over the generations. It is an **LLM judge** (`gemma_med.judge`): the model's response, the options and the gold answer go to `claude-haiku-4-5` under a schema-constrained verdict of `correct` / `incorrect` / `no_answer`.

Why it is a better instrument

- It matches option *content*, not the letter: “A. *[text of option C]*” scores as a choice of C. The regex scored it as A.
- It is told the gold answer and **forbidden to re-derive it**, so the metric stays benchmark accuracy — not agreement between two models.
- `no_answer` is the successor to “unparsed”, so the three-way split survives intact.

What it costs you

- **Judge numbers are not comparable to regex numbers.** It is strictly more generous, so a rise could be the instrument. **Only the 4b arm has been re-scored**; the 270m and 1b tables that follow are still regex.
- The judge is **frozen** per trajectory and recorded in `judged_summary.json`, exactly like the fit corpus and probe set.

Cross-validated. On 300 identical MedQA rows at 4b step-1024, `claude-haiku-4-5` and the lab's self-hosted Kimi agree to within 1.3 pp raw (45.0 vs. 46.3) and 0.3 pp on answer rate. Freezing the judge is about reproducibility, not about either being wrong.

4. Behavior — 4b-it learns, and learns most

Judge-scored. Answered accuracy, with answer rate in parentheses. $t=0$ is the untuned gemma-3-4b-it.

	MedQA		MedMCQA		PubMedQA	
4b-it $t=0$	53.1	(99.5%)	46.8	(99.7%)	58.2	(100%)
4b-it step 512	51.4	(83.8%)	46.2	(89.2%)	73.7	(99.6%)
4b-it final	58.4	(96.5%)	55.1	(92.2%)	72.8	(99.4%)
Δ vs. base	+5.3		+8.3		+14.6	

- **The gain arrives late.** Nothing moves on MedQA/MedMCQA until step ~ 2048 ; the first two thirds of training only degrade format.
- **PubMedQA is the exception** — it climbs from step 16 and is most of the way up by step 512, well before the MCQ benchmarks move.
- **Mid-trajectory raw accuracy is a trap.** Raw MedQA bottoms at 43.0 (step 512) while answered accuracy is 51.4 — see the metrics slide.

Not comparable to the 270m/1b table overleaf: that one is regex-scored on the superseded instrument.

4. Behavior — 270m-it / 1b-it (regex-scored, superseded instrument)

Parsed accuracy (parse rate in parentheses). Retained from the previous version of this deck. These have not been re-scored with the judge and must not be tabulated against the 4b numbers.

	MedQA		MedMCQA		PubMedQA	
270m-it $t=0$	24.6	(69%)	27.2	(13%)	54.5	(7%)
270m-it final	25.5	(49%)	25.0	(49%)	48.0	(5%)
1b-it $t=0$	31.9	(100%)	32.6	(100%)	52.6	(100%)
1b-it final	38.5	(25%)	37.8	(75%)	58.1	(97%)

- **270m learns nothing.** MedQA/MedMCQA sit near chance throughout; every apparent movement is format churn (MedMCQA parse 13%→49%; PubMedQA swings 5%→88%→5%).
- **1b gains +6.6 / +5.2 / +5.5 pp** parsed — while format compliance collapses, worst on MedQA (100% → 25%).

The *qualitative* 270m-vs-1b split (one learns, one only churns format) is instrument-independent. The pp values are not; re-judging both arms is the top item on Next.

4. A second failure mode: collapse onto the majority label

Format collapse is not the only thing that goes wrong mid-training. Share of *answered* items assigned to the dominant label, against that label's prevalence in the gold answers:

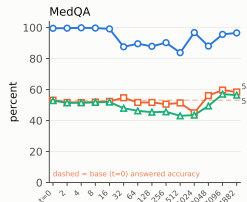
	MedQA ("A")		MedMCQA ("A")		PubMedQA ("yes")	
	chosen	gold	chosen	gold	chosen	gold
$t=0$	21.9	27.7	22.2	32.2	51.2	55.2
step 512	31.4	27.7	41.9	32.2	64.1	55.2
step 1024	57.2	27.7	52.5	32.2	69.9	55.2
final	34.3	27.7	38.5	32.2	65.8	55.2

- The base model is *anti-majority* (21.9 vs. 27.7). SFT pushes it through neutral and overshoots.
- Step 1024 is a spike, not a trend — it recovers. Worth knowing before building a story on any single checkpoint.
- PubMedQA is the control that reframes it. It has no "A" to collapse onto, yet shows the same overshoot on "yes". So this is **majority-label over-commitment, not position bias**.

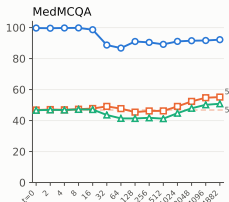
The two modes trade off: steps 32–512 lose format compliance while answered accuracy holds; step 1024 recovers compliance but concentrates its answers; 2048+ resolves both.

4. Joined behavioral + lens trajectory — 4b-it

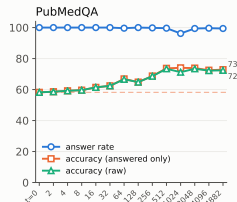
gemma-3-4b-it · medical SFT · behavioral trajectory vs. Jacobian lens



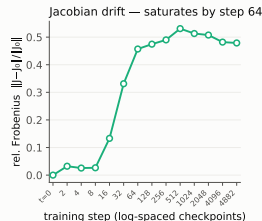
training step (log-spaced checkpoints)



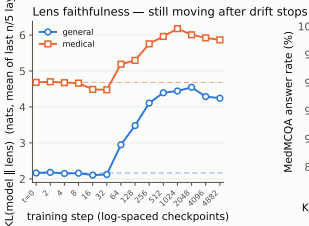
training step (log-spaced checkpoints)



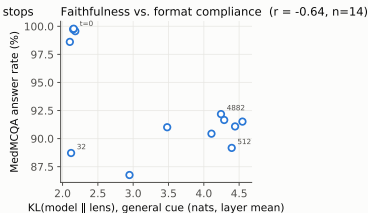
training step (log-spaced checkpoints)



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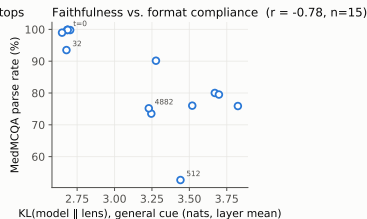
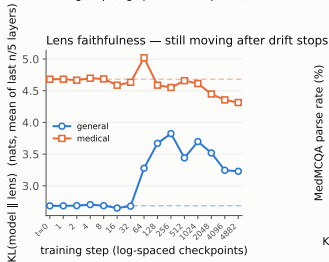
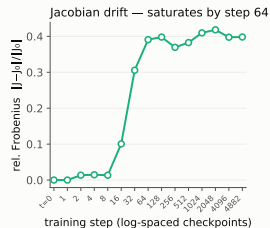
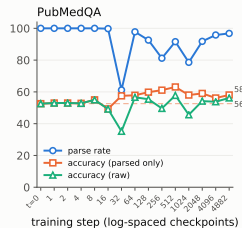
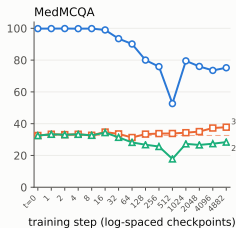
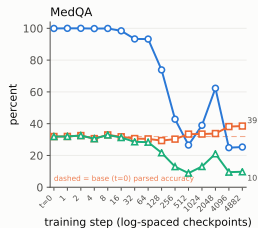


KL(model || lens), general cue (nats, layer mean)

Judge-scored. Top row: answer rate (blue) separates cleanly from answered accuracy (orange) from step 32 — the format/knowledge split made visible.

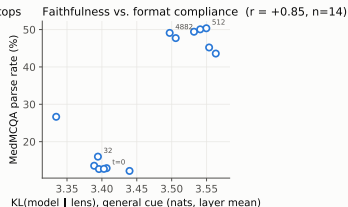
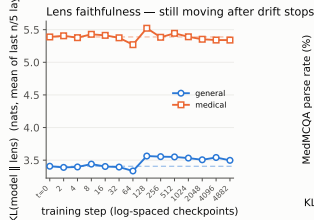
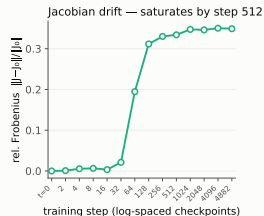
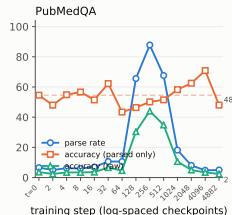
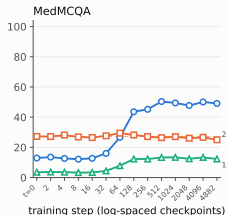
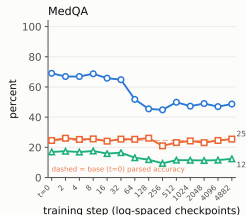
4. Joined behavioral + lens trajectory — 1b-it

Gemma-3-1b-it · medical SFT · behavioral trajectory vs. Jacobian lens



4. Joined behavioral + lens trajectory — 270m-it

Gemma-3-270m-it · medical SFT · behavioral trajectory vs. Jacobian lens



The KL panel is the layer mean, as everywhere else in this deck; at the single final layer the medical curve rises instead.

5. Timing: drift leads format collapse, both lead accuracy

The same ordering holds at both sizes where behavior exists. 4b-it (judge-scored):

Signal	Onset	Notes
Jacobian drift	steps 16–32	0.027 $\rightarrow$ 0.331; plateaus by step 64
Format compliance	step 32	MedQA answer rate 99 $\rightarrow$ 88%, floor 83.8% at 512
Task accuracy	steps 2048+	MedQA answered 51 at step 512; 58–60 only at 4096–4882

And the correlations say which one the lens is tracking:

Pearson r vs. drift	MedQA	MedMCQA	PubMedQA
answer rate (format)	−0.737	−0.912	−0.415
answered accuracy (knowledge)	+0.100	+0.373	+0.910

Interpretation

The Jacobian has **finished moving before the model has learned any medicine**, and it moves *with* format collapse ($r \approx -0.9$ on MedMCQA), not with competence ($r \approx +0.1$ on MedQA). Whatever the lens tracks here is the format / style / alignment shift. *PubMedQA is the exception — its accuracy rises early, on the same clock as drift.*

Caveats — the measurements

- **Top-1 is coarse.** $n=50$ prompts for general/medical (93 for multihop), so *per-layer* top-1 quantizes at 0.02; the reported statistic averages 3 / 5 / 6 layers, giving a 1/150–1/300 grain that makes small moves look more precise than they are. Single-checkpoint wiggles of ± 0.04 are still noise. *Trust the KL trends, not top-1.*
- **Read-out choice is not innocent.** Layer-mean and final-layer KL disagree in sign on 270m medical. Every claim here uses the layer mean; an earlier draft of this deck used the final layer and reported a 270m $\leftrightarrow$ 1b *inversion* that does not survive. Report the statistic, not just the number. (It does not recur at 4b.)
- **A numerical artifact in the drift cosine.** At 4b steps 2–8, `cos_mean` reads 1.001–1.003; cosine cannot exceed 1. The fp32 dot over $\sim 6.5\text{M}$ entries per layer is biased against the stabler norm computation. Only visible where drift ≈ 0 ; no reported claim depends on it, but `jac_drift` should accumulate in fp64.
- **The general/medical cues are hand-authored**, not sampled from a corpus — the domain-gap result inherits whatever bias is in those 100 prompts. `multihop` is the one cue with an external, independently-constructed source.

Caveats — the scope

- **Three sizes is a thin scaling trend.** The monotone cost on general/multihop now rests on three points spanning $\sim 15\times$ in parameters, which is better than the two-point version it replaces — but 270m may simply be too weak to learn the task at all, so the low end is a weak anchor. 12b/27b would settle it.
- **The 4b behavioral arm now exists** — findings 4 and 5 hold at the size where the lens result is strongest. **The gap moved rather than closed:** 4b is judge-scored and 270m/1b are regex-scored, so **no cross-size behavioral comparison is currently legitimate**. Re-judging the two smaller arms ($\sim \$32$ and ~ 22 min each) is what unblocks it.
- **One hyperparameter setting.** All three arms are full FT at lr $1e-5$ on one mixture. Whether the size trend is really about *size*, or about a fixed LR being progressively too large as the model grows, is not separable from these runs alone.
- **Coverage gaps.** The 4b run has no checkpoint-1, so its grid starts at step 2 (270m likewise; only 1b probed step 1). No -pt arm exists at any size — the pt-vs-it starting-point axis is entirely unstated.

Next

1. **Re-judge 270m and 1b** with the same frozen judge — now the most valuable missing piece. Until then the deck has one judge-scored arm and two regex-scored ones, and *no* behavioral claim can be made across sizes. One command per arm, $\sim \$32$ and ~ 22 min each.
2. **12b (LoRA, caveated)** to test whether the monotone cost keeps climbing or turns over. Three points is a direction, not a curve.
3. **Widen the general/medical cues** beyond the 100 hand-authored prompts, to check the domain-gap collapse is not an artifact of how those pairs were written.
4. **Open a -pt arm** at 1b: does a non-aligned starting point show the same drift-before-competence ordering?
5. **Anchor against medgemma-27b-text-it** on the same probe set to place the trajectory endpoints on an absolute scale.

Answered since the last version: the **4b behavioral trajectory now exists** (judge-scored, 14 points incl. $t=0$) — medical SFT gains $+5.3/ +8.3/ +14.6$ pp at 4b, and the drift-leads-format ordering is confirmed at $r = -0.91$. Also: the lens trajectory exists at 4b, and the layer-mean/final-layer disagreement does *not* recur there.

Data provenance

Artifact	Path
Lens metrics (270m)	eval/jlens/270m_it_full/metrics.jsonl (14 rows)
Lens metrics (1b)	eval/jlens/1b_it_full_v3/metrics.jsonl (15 rows)
Lens metrics (4b)	eval/jlens/4b_it_full/metrics.jsonl (14 rows)
Joined traj. (270m)	eval/traj/270m_it_full/joined.json (regex)
Joined traj. (1b)	eval/traj/1b_it_full_v3/joined.json (regex)
Joined traj. (4b)	eval/traj/4b_it_full/joined.json (judge)
Fit corpus	data/jlens/fit_corpus_v2.txt (1000 WikiText seq, frozen)
Probe set	data/jlens/probe_set_v2.tsv (50/50/93, frozen)
Figures	figs/{270m_it_full,1b_it_full_v3,4b_it_full,arms}/
Probe jobs	25776556 (1b), 25799677 (270m), 25948088-25948100 (4b, 13-way fanout)

All three runs logged fit_corpus=1000 probes=193 — i.e. the current frozen v2 inputs. The v1 files (fit_corpus.txt, 40 seq; probe_set.tsv, 30 prompts) are legacy and still present in data/jlens/; they were used only by the superseded runs.

4b was probed one Slurm job per checkpoint (~3.5 h each, ~7 h wall clock vs. ~50 h serial), all 13 workers reusing the same fp32 $t=0$ lens so drift shares one baseline; per-worker rows merged by scripts/merge_jlens_fanout.py, which refuses the merge if any non-base step appears twice. 4b_it_validate{,2} are the earlier 5-point wrapper-validation spikes (base + steps 1–8), superseded.

Superseded: 1b_it_full_v2 (v1 30-prompt set, no multihop), 1b_it_full_probev2 (v2 inputs, immediately re-run as v3), 270m_verify (Phase-0 8-point smoke test, v1 inputs).

Data provenance — the behavioral judge (4b)

Field	Value
Scorer	<code>gemma_med.judge</code> (replaces <code>answer_parsing.py</code>)
Provider	anthropic, Message Batches API (half price)
Judge model	<code>claude-haiku-4-5</code> frozen for the trajectory
Verdicts	<code>correct</code> / <code>incorrect</code> / <code>no_answer</code> , schema-constrained
Volume	83,384 items over 42 batches, ~11 min, ~\$34
Judgments	<code>eval/traj/4b_it_full/step-*/*_judgments.jsonl</code>
Provenance	<code>.../step-*/judged_summary.json</code> (13 files)
<code>t=0</code> dir	<code>eval/gemma-3-4b-it-baseline/</code>

`judge_self_disagreement` — **a quality signal that scores nothing**. It counts rows where the judge's verdict string conflicts with the option it actually picked: 0.2–0.5% at the ends of the trajectory, peaking at 2.8% (step-64 MedMCQA, 117/4183).

It changes no number. `correct` and `answered` are both recomputed from `chosen`, never from `verdict`. Of those 117 rows ~73% are one benign shape: the model emits long “Step 1: Restating the question...” CoT and hits the generation limit before naming an option, so the judge sets `chosen=none` (`correct`) but labels the verdict `incorrect` rather than `no_answer`. The statistic tracks **how rambly the judged model is**, not how confused the judge is — which is why it peaks in the `format-collapse` region and subsides at both ends.